

DataKindled Motion Signature

Status: LOCKED **Purpose:** The consistent motion grammar applied to all animated graphics across the course (Camtasia demos, lesson videos, explainer beats). Applying these three rules the same way every time is what makes the course's motion recognizable and bespoke rather than generic.

The three rules

Rule 1 — Line before fill, always

Every graphic element enters as a drawn outline first (Sketch Motion stroke tracing its shape). Only after the line completes does any fill, color, or text arrive.

- Database icon: outline draws → interior layer-lines fade in
- Card: border draws → content appears inside
- **Why:** "structure first, content second" mirrors the course's own thesis (build the foundation, then everything else) at the level of motion itself. This is what makes the signature bespoke to *this* course rather than generic — the motion means the same thing the course means.

Rule 2 — One thing draws at a time

Elements never draw on simultaneously. They sequence — left to right, or foundation-upward — so the eye follows a deliberate construction path.

- Slower than everything appearing at once, deliberately.
- "Deliberate and unhurried" is the premium/editorial register the course is built around, and the opposite of busy simultaneous motion.

Rule 3 — Terracotta is the completion accent, never the entrance

Elements draw on in Deep Ember ( #1A1A1A) — the structural color). Terracotta ( #C1440E) appears ONLY at the moment of completion or significance.

- The spark mark's tip; the checkmark that lands when a beat resolves; the "PAID" that matters.
 - Every beat builds in restrained dark line-work, then one terracotta moment lands as the point.
 - Reserving the accent this way keeps it considered rather than decorative.
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Applied examples (opening sequence, Chapter 2 Account Setup)

- **Stat card** — cream card border draws (line first) → "DURATION"/"CREDITS" labels fade → "30 days"/"\$400" arrive. No terracotta (informational, not a resolution moment).
 - **Status flip card** — database outline draws in Deep Ember → interior lines fade → status flips → "PAID" lands in terracotta as the completion accent. The terracotta arrival IS the beat's payoff.
 - **Choice cards (cloud/region/edition)** — each card frame draws on in sequence (Rule 2) → content fills after (Rule 1) → small terracotta check lands on confirmation (Rule 3).
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The linked constraint: fewer, better beats

Line-draw-on is slower per beat than fades. Applying this signature strictly means each element takes a moment to construct.

- This is a feature for an editorial course — but only with a TIGHT number of beats.
 - "Unhurried construction" across too many cards becomes "slow."
 - Rule of thumb: prefer fewer beats each given room to draw fully, over many beats each rushing their construction.
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Reproducibility note

This signature was chosen specifically because it is:

- **Reproducible** — three rules applied quickly, not an elaborate bespoke animation per beat that gets skipped by later chapters.
- **Ownable** — line-before-fill tied to the build-the-foundation thesis is distinctive where slide-and-fade is not.
- **Already half-built** — Sketch Motion works; the spark mark and database icon are already line-drawn; terracotta-as-accent is already how the spark mark treats its tip.

The signature must be executable quickly and consistently through Chapter 15, not stunning once and slow to reproduce. Consistency across the whole course matters more than peak sophistication on any single beat.